

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

about putting extra pressure on you if they're aware of any money worries that you're having, which can create a painful cocktail of conflicting emotions for them. I have spoken to countless people on both sides of the equation, and I've been in both situations myself. It's painful to be either person in the situation, but if you're the one who's done the hurting, no matter how unintentional, no matter how much you were also hurting yourself at the same time, it is up to you to be the one to make amends. I promise, you'll feel better for it.

There is a reason why 'making amends' comes later on in the various programmes that people use for getting back on track when their life has taken a rogue turn.¹ It takes strength and resilience to face the fact that our actions affect people other than ourselves, and when you are still at the very early, vulnerable stages of self-forgiveness, that strength and resilience might not yet be reliable, or even present at all. So, when you're ready, here are a few ways that you can look at broaching the conversation:

- Meet the person in a neutral place. A walk is always nice – I always find difficult conversations flow easier when there's some movement involved, and fresh air is often a bit of an antidote to anxiety.
- Don't beat around the bush. Your intention with this conversation is to apologize, and the longer you draw it out, the more difficult it will be. A good opening line is 'I want to talk to you about the time when I did X. It was wrong of me, and I owe you an apology. I'm really sorry.'